



A portion of the Caltech/MIT team of LIGO scientists in late 1991. *Left:* Some Caltech members of the team, counterclockwise from upper left: Aaron Gillespie, Fred Raab, Maggie Taylor, Seiji Kawamura, Robbie Vogt, Ronald Drever, Lisa Sievers, Alex Abramovici, Bob Spero, Mike Zucker. *Right:* Some MIT members of the team,. counterclockwise from upper left: Joe Kovalik, Yaron Hefetz, Nergis Mavalvala, Rainer Weiss, David Schumaker, Joe Giaime. [Left: courtesy Ken Rogers/ Black Star; right: courtesy Erik L. Simmons.

"It will be painful working with Robbie," a former member of his millimeter team told us. "You will emerge bruised and scarred, but it will be worth it. Your project will succeed."

For several months Drever, Weiss, I, and others pleaded with Vogt to take the directorship. He finally accepted; and, as promised, six years later our Caltech/MIT team is bruised and scarred, but effective, powerful, tightly knit, and growing rapidly toward the critical size (about fifty scientists and engineers) required for success. Success, however, will not depend on us alone. Under Vogt's plan important inputs to our core effort will come from other scientists[10] who, by being only loosely associated with us, can maintain the individualistic, free-wheeling style that we have left behind.